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Hen-Berry carries her basket towards the picnic. Snap! The handle breaks. Berries tumble across the path. She scoops them into her wings, but each time she bends down, another berry rolls away.



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Ted-E-Bear wants to share an idea. “You need a basket with a stronger handle.”
Hen-Berry watches a berry roll past his foot. “Could you pick that up first?” she asks.



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Wise Owl stops beside them. “What would help?” Hen-Berry shows her full wings. Wise Owl listens, and Ted brings a bowl. At last Hen-Berry can put the berries down.



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They set off with a small bowl each. Hen-Berry can walk without dropping anything. “Next time,” says Ted, “I will ask first.” Hen-Berry smiles. “You can help carry these now.”

Questions for Hen-Berry’s Helping Day

Read the story together first. Use the page prompts and the questions after reading. Answers are below the dotted line: fold them under or cover them while reading.

Page 1

Talk together: Why is gathering the berries difficult for Hen-Berry?

Page 2

Talk together: Why does Hen-Berry ask Ted to pick up the berry first?

Page 3

Talk together: How does asking and listening help the friends choose what to do?

Page 4

Talk together: What has Ted learned about helping a friend?

After reading 1

Why was bringing a bowl more useful than giving basket advice?

After reading 2

What did Wise Owl do to help?

Answers (fold under before reading)

After reading 1: It let Hen-Berry put down the berries she was holding. Listening helped Ted solve the problem Hen-Berry had right then.

After reading 2: Asked Hen-Berry what would help and listened.